



REUBEN SINGH

Tea-ing Off

RAJASTHAN



PURUSHOTTAM DIWAKAR

(FROM LEFT) PRAKASH
JAVADEKAR, GOPINATH
MUNDE AND
CHIEF MINISTER
VASUNDHARA RAJE

With just a month to go before the state polls, Rajasthan Chief Minister Vasundhara Raje hosted a tea party for the media. Her last informal interaction with the press had been during the Jaipur serial bomb blasts and the Gujar agitation. This time, she says, there is no crisis. "I want to have fun for the next month now," she laughed, talking anything but politics. Unlike the Congress which has released its first list, the BJP is yet to finalise its names. Raje smiled when she heard about the fireworks in the opposition camp. "That way our Diwali has been very nice, really nice," she said. *by Rohit Parihar*

NO, HOME MINISTER

The Congress units in all the election-bound states have made a rather unusual request to the party in Delhi: Please do not send Shivraj Patil to campaign for the elections! Apart from Rahul and Sonia Gandhi, the party also sends a team of Central ministers and neighbouring chief ministers to the states. But with the BJP making terrorism its main plank, and fielding L.K. Advani along with its neo-Iron Man, Narendra Modi, Congress units are worried that the somewhat effete image of the dapper home minister may not work in its favour. So the message to Patil from the cadres is: Please stay at home! *by Priya Sahgal*



SAURASH SINGH